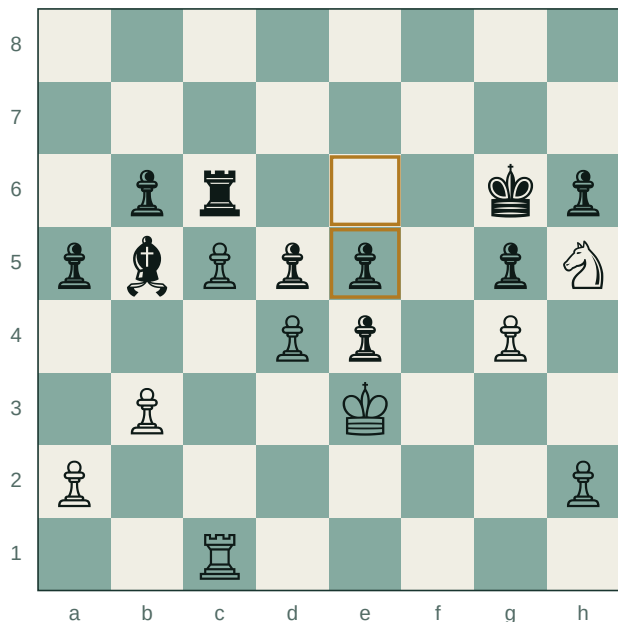


# Calculated sacrifices: White, move 30

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 29...e5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**30. cxb6 Rxc1 31. b7 Re1+ 32. Kd2**

**30.cxb6** The pawn captures the pawn on b6. The changed line means the rook on c1 attacks the rook on c6. Recorded reply: **30...Rxc1**.

**31.b7** The pawn moves from b6 to b7. Recorded reply: **31...Re1+**.

**32.Kd2** The king moves from e3 to d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -4: the balance goes from -1 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b5. Check for tactical protection.